

MEDIEVAL HISTORY



MODULE - 32

**PREVIOUS YEARS QUESTIONS
&
PRACTICE MCQ**



MCQ NO - 1

Consider the following about Sul-i-kul. Which of the following is correct?

- a) It is an idea of universal peace in Akbar's governance.
- b) It is unique system of painting in Jehangir's court.
- c) It was a form of architecture imported from Persia.
- d) None of the above.

 Learning Space **EXPLANATION** Learning Space

- Sulh-i kul is an Arabic term literally meaning “peace with all,” “universal peace,” or “absolute peace,” drawn from a Sufi mystic principle.
 - As applied by the third Mughal Emperor of India, Akbar (who reigned 1556-1605), it described a peaceful and harmonious relationship among different religions.
 - In keeping with efforts to mesh the diverse populations of his reign, Akbar proposed unity and peace among all human beings
 - The concept implies not just tolerance, but also the sorts of balance, civility, respect, and compromise required to maintain harmony among a diverse population
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- Learning Space

MCQ NO - 2

With reference to the cultural history during Mughal India, consider the following statements:

1. 'Pietra Dura', method of decorating walls with floral designs was started during Jahangir's reign.
2. Mughal painting reached its zenith under Jahangir.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

EXPLANATION

- In Mughal India, pietra dura was known as *Parchin kari*, literally 'inlay' or 'driven-in' work. Its works are extensively found in the Taj mahal.
- The practice of putting up buildings in marble and decorating the walls with floral designs made of semi-precious stones (known as Pietra Durra) started during Jahangir's reign.
- The Mughal period in Indian history had seen widespread cultural development, especially in the field of miniature paintings.
- Mughal painting reached its zenith under Jahangir. He employed a number of painters like Abul Hasan, Bishan Das (regarded as master of portraits), Madhu, Anant, Manohar, Govardhan and Ustad Mansur (specialist in animal painting).
- The use of 'Halo' or 'Divine lights' behind king's head started under him. Apart from painting the scenes of hunting, battles and royal courts, progress was made in portrait painting and paintings of animals.

MCQ NO - 3

Which of the statements given below is/are true about Shah Jahan?

1. His reign is considered the 'The Golden age' of the Mughal Empire.
2. Mosque-building reached its peak during Shah Jahan's reign.
3. The climax of fort-building reached during the reign of Shah Jahan.

Choose appropriate option:

- a) 3 only
- b) 1 and 3
- c) 2 and 3
- d) 1, 2 and 3

EXPLANATION

- Shah Jahan's reign is considered the 'The Golden age' of the Mughal Empire. He built Taj Mahal, counted among seven wonders of the world and considered a jewel of the builder's art.
- Mosque-building reached its peak during Shah Jahan's reign. He built the Moti Masjid at Agra (built entirely in white marble), the Sheesh Mahal and Mussaman Burj at Agra (where he spent his last years in captivity), while the Jama Masjid at Delhi was built in red stone.
- The climax of fort-building reached during the reign of Shah Jahan. The famous Red Fort at Delhi with its Rang Mahal, Diwan-i-Am, and Diwan-i-Khas was his creation.
- He also built the Jama Masjid in Delhi, Shalimar Bagh in Lahore, and the city of Shahjahanabad.
- He also got Bebadal Khan to build the Peacock Throne.

MCQ NO - 4

Consider the following statements with reference to Mansabdari System:

1. Mansabdari System was a Mongolian tradition developed by Mughals.
2. The mansab rank was hereditary.
3. Akbar introduced the Mansabdari system in his administration.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 2 only
- b) 1 and 3
- c) 2 and 3
- d) 1, 2 and 3

EXPLANATION**MANSABDARI SYSTEM :**

- It was a civil cum Military system
- Mansab means rank in Persian and mansabdar means rank holder.
- It was a Mongolian tradition which was later developed by Mughals especially Akbar.
- There were 66 ranks in all and each mansabdar held two ranks – Zat and Sawar.
- Zat was the personal rank of the mansabdar and Sawar was the number of horsemen that he had to maintain.
- The mansabdars used to get lands (Jagir) as salary. Hence they were also called Jagirdars.
- The mansab rank was *not hereditary*.
- All appointments and promotions as well as dismissals were directly made by the emperor.



MCQ NO - 5

Which one of the following is the correct chronological order of the Afghan rulers to the throne of Delhi?

- a) Sikandar Shah - Ibrahim Lodi- Bahlol Khan Lodi
- b) Sikandar Shah - Bahlol Khan Lodi- Ibrahim Lodi
- c) Bahlol Khan Lodi - Sikandar Shah- Ibrahim Lodi
- d) Bahlol Khan Lodi - Ibrahim Lodi- Sikandar Shah

MCQ NO - 6

Which of the below given statements is/are true about Dara Shikoh?

1. He translated 50 upanishads from Sanskrit to Persian under the name 'Sirr-e-Akbar'.
2. He was a follower of Qadri Sufi sect.
3. He wrote Majma-ul-Bahrain.

Choose appropriate option:

- a) 1 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

EXPLANATION

- Dara Shikoh was the eldest son of Shah Jahan and he was named as the crown Prince.
- In struggle of succession, he was killed by his younger brother Aurangzeb.
- Dara Shikoh was known as the 'Little Akbar' and was seen as the confluence of two seas – Hinduism and Islam.
- He was a follower of Qadri Sufi sect.
- Dara Shukoh devoted much effort towards finding a common mystical link between Islam and Hinduism. Towards this goal he completed the translation of fifty Upanishads from their original Sanskrit into Persian
- His translation is often called Sirr-e-Akbar ("The Greatest Mystery")
- He was also a patron of fine arts, music and dancing.
- Dara Shikoh had commissioned the translation of all the Upanishads from Sanskrit to Persian for Muslim scholar to learn.
- He wrote the Majma-ul-Bahrain (The confluence of two seas) to elaborate upon the sync between Sufism and Vedic philosophies.

MCQ NO - 7

Consider the following statements with reference to Al-Biruni:

1. He was patronized by Sultan Muhammad Ghori.
2. His Arabic work, known as the Kitab ul-Hind remain an important source of account of Indian subcontinent.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 Only
- b) 2 Only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2



EXPLANATION



- In 1017 AD, when Sultan Mahmud of Ghazni invaded Khwarizm, he took several scholars and poets back to his capital, Ghazni
- Al-Biruni was one of them. Hence, He was patronised and came to India with Muhammad of Ghazni
- Sultan Mahmud entrusted Al-Biruni a task to write an account of the subcontinent, which culminated into Kitab ul-Hind.
- Al-Biruni spent years in the company of Brahmana priests and scholars, learning Sanskrit, and studying religious and philosophical texts



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ANSWER KEY

1 - a

2 - c

3 - d

4 - b

5 - c

6 - d

7 - b

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